Colour for your website and business

Yes, mainly where you sell depth, elegance and focus. Black promises seriousness, but can easily feel unapproachable.

In business, black is a colour that **invites trust**, but at the same time carries a label of austerity. It can look luxurious, serious, modern and also mysterious. That is why it is good to know what you are promising before you let it into your logo, website or advert.

By itself, though, it **does not attract customers** like a magnet. It can help create **a striking impression**, but what still decides is mainly **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Black can say, for example

"It's premium." "It's serious." "It's modern." "It's private."

- **Luxury and elegance.** Black is often used in fashion, photography, jewellery and premium services.
- **Authority.** Law, finance and professional services. Too many dark surfaces and austere wording, though, can feel unapproachable.
- **Privacy.** A dark surrounding feels intimate. One must be able to read the menu in it and move about safely.
- **Contrast.** A dark background highlights the shine of metal, light ceramics or a striking photograph.
- **Coldness.** Without a warm companion it can seem aloof.

Depending on the shade it also feels different. Anthracite and charcoal are **modern and restrained**, warm soot **softer and tangible**, pure black **striking and graphic**.

© 2026 MatyRoss · The Art of Wholeness. All rights reserved. Copying, distribution or any other use of the content without the author's written permission is not allowed.

Simple tips

- **Add light**
  A light background or a white area adds distance. Keep large areas calm.
- **Show the product**
  A black handbag on a black background can be elegant, if a person actually finds it.
- **Shade by role**
  Pure black for graphics, anthracite for professionalism, warm for friendliness.
- **Legibility**
  Light lettering on a dark background is not automatically comfortable for everyone. Watch size, contrast and the length of text.
- **A human face**
  Authority does not have to stand in the doorway with folded arms. Add clear language and a photograph.
- **Colour blindness**
  About 1 in 12 men has difficulty telling red from green. Black text on a light background is the safest choice for most people.

Professions where it is a Yes

The rule is simple. When you sell exceptionality, depth or privacy, black can help you.

Fashion, jewellery and original work

A dark background can highlight the shine of metal, light ceramics or a striking photograph. With dark products, though, make sure they do not disappear.

Photography, film and culture

Black lets the image, the light and the detail stand out. It suits a gallery, a cinema and a poster.

Law, finance and professional services

Black can support a serious and restrained impression. If you want people not to be afraid to get in touch, add clear language and a human face.

Restaurants, bars and social spaces

A dark surrounding can feel intimate and festive. One must be able to read the menu in it and move about safely, though. Mystery is pleasant in the story of a wine. Less so with the question of where the step ends.

© 2026 MatyRoss · The Art of Wholeness. All rights reserved. Copying, distribution or any other use of the content without the author’s written permission is not allowed.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Caring for people.** Without warmer elements black can feel aloof.
- **Playful and light services.** For services promising lightness and playfulness it may create different expectations.
- **Poorly lit waiting rooms and corridors.** More dark surfaces can strengthen the heaviness.
- **Long texts on a website.** Light lettering on a dark background is not automatically the most comfortable for everyone.
- **Presenting skin, food or coloured products.** A black filter can distort real colours.

Most important is not whether a design looks expensive. It is whether a person understands where they have come and what they can expect.

Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer and ask "What would you expect from such a place or service?" **Is the offer visible, or mainly the black?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that black means elegance.

A question for you

"What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?"

© 2026 MatyRoss · The Art of Wholeness. All rights reserved. Copying, distribution or any other use of the content without the author's written permission is not allowed.

Examples from the market

You know black from notebooks, pens and shoes. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Moleskine (stationery)**
  The brand was founded in Milan in 1997 by Maria Sebregondi. The notebooks have black hard covers, an elastic band and ivory paper. They follow on from the French carnets moleskines that Bruce Chatwin wrote about in his 1987 book The Songlines.

- **Montblanc (writing instruments)**
  The company arose in Berlin in 1906 and was later based in Hamburg. The white star appeared in 1913 and the name Meisterstück was first used in 1924. Black here stands next to a white emblem.

- **Air Jordan 1 (footwear)**
  The basketball shoe was on sale from 1 April 1985. According to available data it had only 23 percent white, while the NBA required 51, and Nike paid a $5,000 fine per game. The "Banned" advert turned it into a story. Black became a protest and an advert.

- **Ray-Ban Wayfarer (glasses)**
  The model was designed in 1952 by Raymond Stegeman for Bausch & Lomb with a new plastic-moulding technology. The dark frame became its hallmark.

What they have in common is that black carries a simple message. **Seriously, strikingly, without apology.** And it mostly does not outweigh what is around it.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

© 2026 MatyRoss · The Art of Wholeness. All rights reserved. Copying, distribution or any other use of the content without the author’s written permission is not allowed.